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THE AMATEUR GAME

In this section we are presenting four games played and annotated by amateur players, with some master commentary and questions by the editor

I think there are four main areas of chess:-

- Development and piece placing
- Central control by pawns and space control
- King safety
- Material balance

Over all these ideas there is the ability to make tactical calculations and analyse and this often decides whether one side will go ahead on material or whether an attack on the king will be successful.

When you play through these games, try to relate the shifts of advantage and disadvantage back to your four main principles. For example, in game 1, white's sacrifice of material by 10. NxQP is an attempt to expose the enemy king; later, the balance of the game goes towards black because the black king is insufficiently exposed to justify the piece deficit.

In game 2, the interest revolves around the material attacks on the kings. At one point the black king is very exposed because of poor pawn cover, but when white dallies with his onslaught, black strikes back strongly and dismantles the defences around the white king.

Game 3 sees an interesting central battle and white emerges with extra material, better central control and better placed pieces.

Game 4 is also a complex struggle in the middle of the board. When black's attack becomes menacing against the king, white sacrifices his queen for two rooks but also gains a strong attack against the black king.

So in all these games the threads can be continually discovered; needless to say, it is tactics, time and time again, which decide the success or otherwise of the manouvres; in game 1, black throws away a promising position by capturing a pawn too early at Q4 with his bishop; and in game 3, black gets a decisive disadvantage when he misses a discovered attack on his knight at KR4. This, not only loses him a pawn, but a lot of central control as well.

White: Victor
Black: George

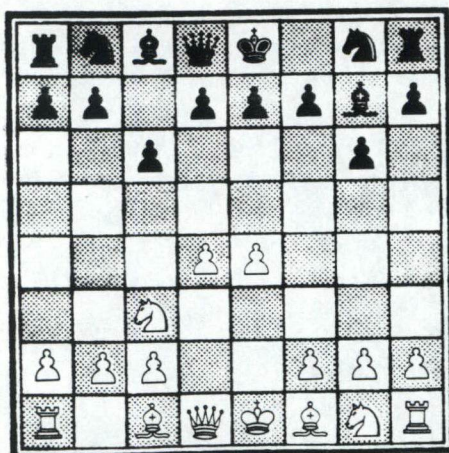
Notes by Victor Mathias
(Notes in brackets by the Editor)

1. P-K4 P-KN3

The, so-called, Modern Defence.
Much touted by Ray Keene who had
some fine wins as black with it.
My own experience, however, is that
I usually lose as black and win as

white against it.

2. P-Q4 B-N2
3. N-QB3 P-QB3

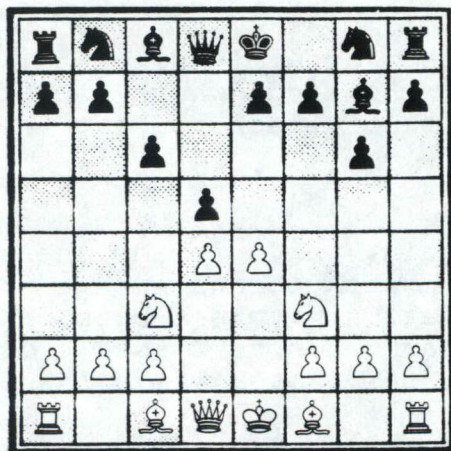


George's QBP, especially when he has black, seldom stays still for long. Here it opens a diagonal for his queen, prepares ... P-Q4 and hampers any further immediate advance by my QN.

4. N-B3

A classical set-up for white. George often lets me get this far then, without apparent difficulty, undermines my powerful centre and gains an advantage.

4. ... P-Q4



My centre is broken.

(Black has chosen a different line of the Modern Defence, called the Gurgendidze Defence, named after the Georgian grandmaster. In the normal Modern Defence, black fianchettoes his bishop at KN2 and then plays ... P-Q3 and later ... P-QB4 or ... P-K4. In this way the pawns in the centre help the bishop at g7 by attacking the same central squares as the bishop.

The Gurgendidze line, however, places the pawns at QB3 and Q4 (see diagram). This gives black a more solid game in the centre; as the pawn at d5 is very hard to dislodge. The main disadvantage is that by not playing P-QB4, black's bishop is somewhat stifled at KN2 - but you can't have everything! Another plus of the Gurgendidze line is that black does not play ... P-K3, as in the French Defence, and, therefore, the black bishop at QB1 has good development prospects at KB4 and KN5.)

5. PxP PxP
6. B-QN5ch B-Q2
7. BxBch QxB

I expected ... NxB but George aims to put his QN on its 'natural' c6 square.

8. O-O N-QB3
9. R-K1 N-R3

Again unexpected. Presumably George wished to avoid blocking up his fianchettoed bishop.

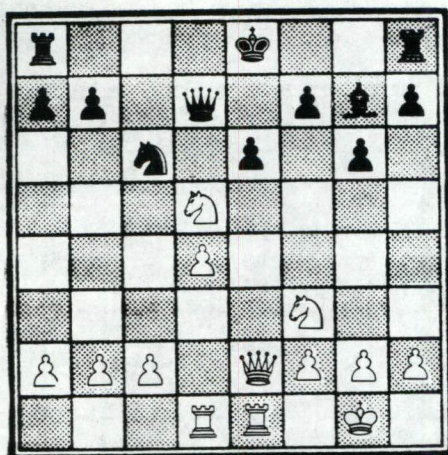
10. BxN

George said this surprised him; but I reckoned his knight had quite a future if allowed to use h6 as a spring board. What's more, my move brought George's bishop temporarily off the long diagonal.

10. ... BxB
11. Q-K2 B-N2
12. QR-Q1

I reckon that I'm now very well placed on the central files.

12. ... P-K3
13. NxP?!



After having a good look at this, George called it 'splendiferous', but I'm not so sure. The point of the move is that after ... QxN 14. P-B4! and his queen gets chased around. Meanwhile, though, he has got a piece for a pawn. George was of the opinion that 'all hell would break loose' is he played ... QxN; so he played safe instead and let me have the pawn.

(Would you have taken the knight? See editor's comment at the end of the game.)

13. ... 0-0
14. N-B4

If I go back to QB3, then I think George wins back his pawn. The purpose of my going to f4 instead is that, after say ... BxP? I have 15. P-B3! as a riposte; so, in effect, George can't recapture the pawn yet.

14. ... Q-B2!

Hitting my f4 knight and removing his queen from the dangerous d file.

What should I do here; Supine moves, such as N-R3, N-Q3 or P-KN3, give George the chance to put his rooks on the d and/or c files. So I adopt an alternative course of action which maintains my initiative. Can you see it?

15. NxKP!?

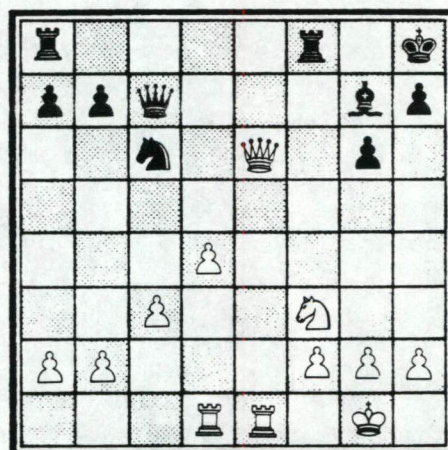
This time my kamikaze knight has to be taken because it forks George's

Queen and king's rook.

15. ... PxN
16. QxPch

In return for this second proffer of a sacrifice, I get - as I pointed out candidly to George, 'two pawns and a check and perhaps not much else'. But, all in all, I have 3 pawns for the 'lost' knight and retain central control and my initiative.

16. ... K-R1
17. P-B3



Absolutely essential I think. It hampers, all at one go, George's knight and his fianchettoed bishop and protects my own QF which - in case you've not noticed - is now a passed pawn which can hope for a great future.

17. ... N-Q1

George could perhaps more effectively have attacked my queen with a rook, but he recognised that his knight needs to be repositioned, so gained a tempo to that end with the move chosen.

18. Q-R3

Aiming at George's king and hoping to get the opportunity to see whether N-N5 is any good.

18. ... N-B2

The knight adds itself to the king's defences and also guards

the g5 square.

19. R-K6

Aggressive, but I think justified. I feel impelled in this game to do all in my power to keep my attack going. Incidentally, this move also threatens 20. RXP! Did you notice?

19. ... K-N1

Strangely enough, this seems to be the only move that saves George's pawn - ... Q-Q2 maybe?

(Do you agree with this comment?
Answer at the end. Ed.)

20. R(1)-K1

The tempo gained by me previous move gives me this opportunity to double my rooks on the key open file.

20. ... Q-Q2

This, in effect, pins my rook for, if I move it, then ... QxQ! turns the tables completely.

21. Q-R4

Slightly awkward, but this move breaks the aforementioned 'pin', means that George no longer has any future possibility of forking my queen and rook if I leave g5 unguarded, maintains a bit of pressure on George's h pawn and aims my queen at both e7 and e4.

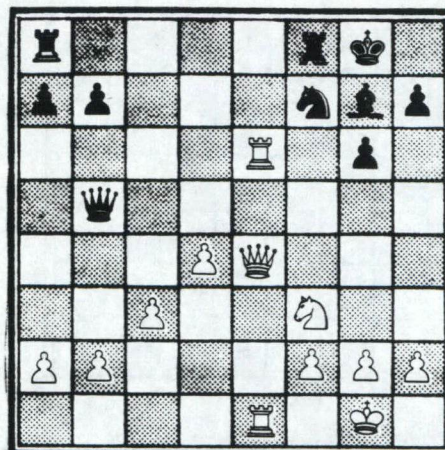
21. ... Q-N4!

Threatens my QNP at the same time as permitting ... QR-K1! next, which would end my hegemony along the e file.

22. Q-K4

Giving up my b pawn so as to stop my hold on the e file being ended.

Not for the first or last time in this intriguing game, I gamble all on maintaining my initiative.



Would Kasparov, on seeing this position, do the same as I did, or would he laugh at me for my foolhardiness? George, in our postmortem, said that in view of my 4 to 2 pawn majority on the queen side, he'd probably have safeguarded the queen side pawns, hoping that they alone would be enough to give him eventual victory. But George is a more solid and patient player than I am - this is all there is to it! (22. b3 followed by c4 and d5 looks promising - the pawns are beginning to look dangerous.)

22. ... QxP

After this capture, putting him a pawn up, I have only 2 pawns now for my piece, George has two more pawns to choose from if he wants to go on gobbling.

23. R-K7

Establishing a rook on the 7th rank, and winning the black b pawn if George takes either my a or my c pawn immediately. In fact, I threaten to win the b pawn anyway, or place two pieces on his 7th rank if he replies ... P-N3.

23 ... QR-N1

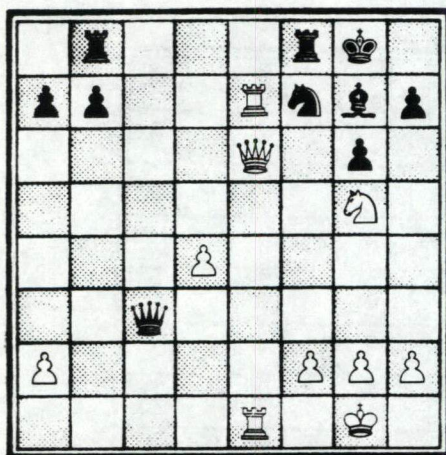
See what I mean, solid and patient

24 Q-K6

Pinning George's knight but sacrificing another of my queenside pawns in the process

24 . . QxQBP
25. N-N5!?

This looks obvious because it wins George's pinned knight and when I played it George said straight away, "Yes, that's the best move in this position." But before making my decision I'd looked long and hard at 25 P-Q5 instead. This move would seem to make my passed pawn very hard to stop and would 'rescue' it from the double attack upon it by George's queen and bishop. I concluded, though, that the move would have been an error because it allows George to play ... Q-KB3!, whereupon my attacking possibilities seem to fizzle out.



25. ... QxRch?!

After long experience of George as an opponent, this is what I expected him to play. Several times in our recent tussles he has given up his queen for this and that and I've still been unable to beat him!

26. QxQ NxN

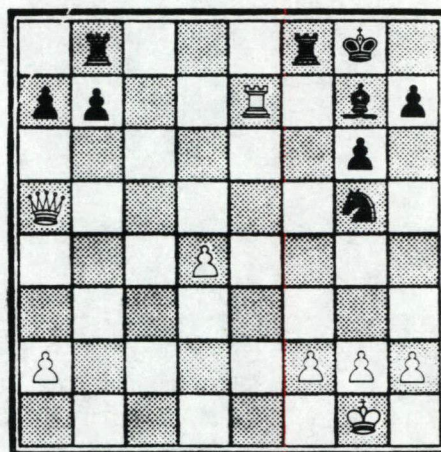
So he gets rook and knight for his queen, plus a nice open file for his king's rook. Not a bad bargain,

if you consider what a predicament George was facing after my move 25.

27. Q-R5!

Following, as mentioned above, my recent lack of success against George when I had a queen and he did not, I felt inclined at this juncture, to demonstrate beyond dispute what has been described as the queen's 'awesome power'! This move forks George's QRP and his hanging knight; but it also has a more subtle purpose= In certain lines it will afford me a nice subsequent check on d5. What's more, I may be enabled to invade the 7th rank afresh with Q-B7.

Alas, very few moves are all good and my move 27 leaves f2 unprotected and may make a back-rank mate possible for George to engineer if he plays his 'cards' right.



(What would you play for black here?)

27. ... BxP

Is George crazy? Is he giving me a piece for nothing? Why doesn't he do something about 28. QxN? I had, in fact, foreseen this possibility for George. Look at it; if 28. QxN?, then ... BxPch! 29. K-R1 BxR5! may be good enough at least to draw for him, if not to get an outright win.

This is where the third point of my move 27 comes in, the check made available to me on d5.

28. Q-Q5ch!

Doesn't this win? After 29. QxB George's threats against f2 would be at an end.

28. ... N-K3

An amazing move! Smacking of desperation, yes, but the gallant knight, as I told George, says, 'Take me, not My Lord, the bishop!' I must confess, incidentally, that when I first saw this move I thought George had won. The knight jumps off g5 and protects the key black bishop. When my initial stupefaction subsided, I did at length notice that the knight itself remained still en prise... I nevertheless continue to say this is an amazing move; George realises that his life depends on his bishop. He is willing to give up almost everything to maintain the bishop on d4 pointing at f2.

(What should white play now? answer at end.)

29. QxNch K-R1

30. Q-Q7

Much better would have been 30. P-KN3. My first undoubted error yet, when I make this move, I felt it was strong enough to win by itself. 'Overconfidence again!' The move threatens 29. RxPch, or 29. QxBch! And if 30. ... BxPch (which I had expected) 31. K-R1 and I have an unstoppable mate in the corner.

(30. P-KR3 looks simplest here; if BxPch 31. K-R2 and white should win.)

30. ... QR-Q1!!

Instead of victory, defeat stares me in the face. Here you can at last see why George had striven

so hard to maintain his bishop on d4. It not only threatens f2, it also saves George from possible mate on g7.

I have only one move to save me. Can you find it?

31. Q-R4!

Saves my queen and guards against a back row mate on d1. (My f pawn, of course, cannot be saved.)

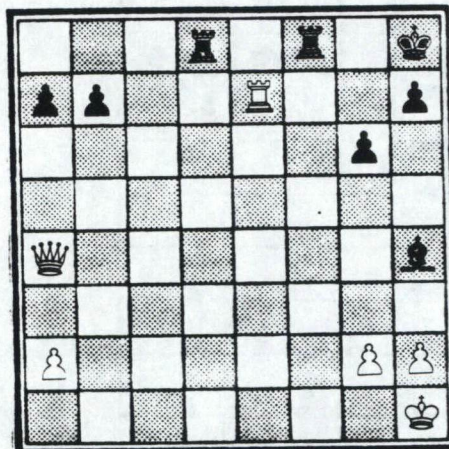
31. ... BxPch

32. K-R1

Clearly, K-B1 is much worse.

32. ... B-R5?!

Looks marvellous doesn't it. Hits my rook and threatens mate on f1 at the same time. Nor can my rook achieve anything but suicide by returning to e1. But when I heard from George that he had chosen this move I knew I was safe.



33. RxRPch!

KxR

34. QxBch

drawn

The check gives me a tempo in which to advance one of my kingside pawns.

(Note B. The capture 13. ... QxN 14. P-QB4 is indeed dangerous as white threatens to open the central files by P-Q5. However, black can accept the offer. After 14 ... Q-QR4 15. P-Q5 N-Q1, black will be able to castle king side and spirit his king away from the centre; e.g.

15. PxP NxP 16. R-Q5 QxRP 17. N-N5
O-O 18. NxN PxN 19. QxPch K-R1
and black should win.

After 19. R-K1, besides Q-Q2
black can also play 19. ... N-R3.
If then 20. N-N5 QxKB5! reasserts
black's superiority. Basically,
three pawns should not be worth
a piece unless they are queening
threats and black should be see-
king opportunities to find more
active positions for his men.

After 19. ... N-R3 a better
chance for white is 20. P-Q5
though black can still play act-
ively with 20. ... Q-KB5 21. P-Q6
QR-Q5 22. P-Q7 N-N5 and now
23. RXP is met by N-K4 or RXP due
to the tactical nature of the
position.

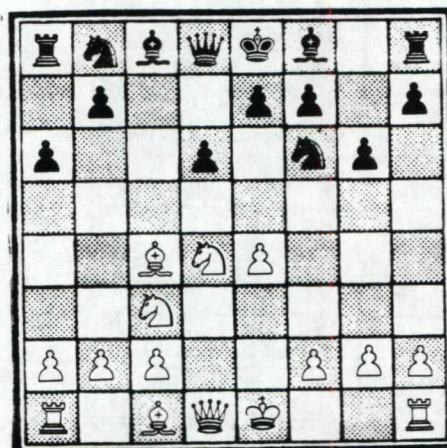
27. ... BxP is a bad blunder.
Black has still the material ad-
vantage as a queen is not worth
rook and two minor pieces. But
black should first consolidate
and attempt to win the king
pawn at Q4 later. So black is
correct in thinking that winning
the d pawn will give him the
advantage because it so enhances
the scope of his bishop, but is
too impatient to do so.

After 27. ... N-B2! 28. QxP
QR-Q1 29. QxP BxP black has
consolidated and is ready to
launch a counterattack against
the white KB2 square.

GAME 2 Alan - White
Victor - Black

(Notes in brackets by editor.)

- | | |
|----------|-------|
| 1. P-K4 | P-QB4 |
| 2. N-KB3 | P-Q3 |
| 3. P-Q4 | PxP |
| 4. NxP | N-KB3 |
| 5. N-QB3 | P-QR3 |
| 6. B-QB4 | P-KN3 |



Sicilian Najdorf.
Aiming for my favourite 'combina-
tion' of openings in the Sicilian,
i.e. the 'Najdorf Dragon'.

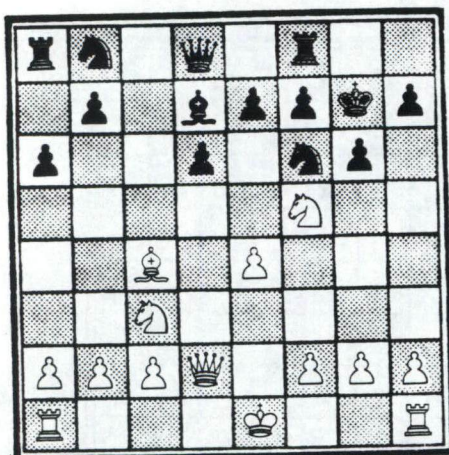
- | | |
|---------|------|
| 7. B-K3 | B-N2 |
| 8. Q-Q2 | |

Gunning towards h6 and the exchange
of my fianchettoed bishop. This
is one of Alan's standard ploys,
which he tends to stick to through
thick and thin. It nullifies my
fianchetto and draws my king for-
ward into Alan's intended king-
side attack; but I ignore the
ploy and carry on my queenside
development after castling.

- | | |
|----------|------|
| 8. ... | O-O |
| 9. B-KR6 | B-Q2 |
| 10. BxB | KxB |

By allowing the exchange of his
bishops on g7 rather than on h6
I put my king where it prevents
Alan's queen coming to the h
file for the present. Alan is
playing as if he really means
business today!

11. N-B5+



(Would you have played Bxf5 or gxf5 here? Answer at the end of the game.)

11. ... BxN
12. PxB

Alan now has doubled f pawns and he has opened up the e file. If I take the pawn, my king becomes very exposed and Alan recaptures on f5 after checking me with his queen on g5. Obviously I cannot play ... P-KN4. So it looks good for Alan, but I think the foray is a bit premature. Alan is trying to do too much with his queen alone.

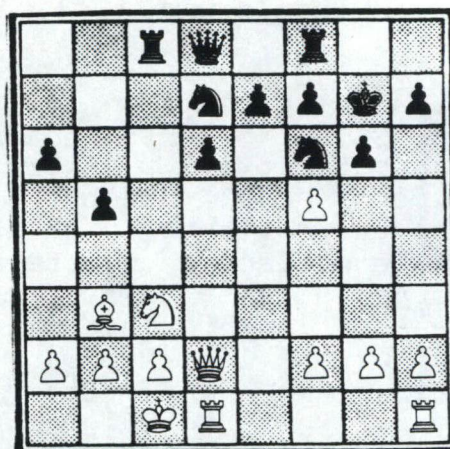
12. ... QN-Q2

Again, let Alan do his worst - I'm going to concentrate on queen side development.

13. O-O-O?!

A key decision. We're bound to have an exciting tussle after this. To castle queenside in preparation for a kingside attack appears logical policy for Alan, but it is very dangerous for him too, since I have the open c file for my counter-attack and his king is now in my firing line.

13. ... R-QB1
14. B-N3 P-QN4



After much cogitation I made this move without any specific plan in mind; but it is usually thought to be a good strategic move for black in the Sicilian and the rest of my army seemed well enough placed already. In other words, this is an instinctive advance, rather than a measured one.

15. PxP

This sets me a problem which, as it turned out, Alan failed to capitalise on. Recapture with my bishop pawn looks natural as it results in my king's rook getting an open file; but I suddenly noticed that my K3 square was now unprotected. What's more, Alan's bishop is bearing down upon it.

15. ... BPxP

Perhaps ... RPxP would have been safer, followed by ... R-KR1.

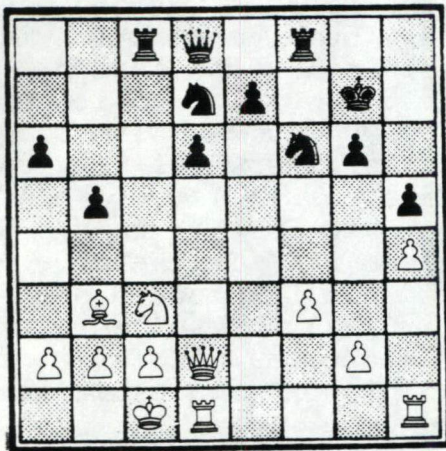
16. P-KR4

Here commenceth the old Alan Wicken pawn roller.

16. ... P-KR4

Unpleasant, but I think forced as 17. P-R5 would have been awful for me.

17. P-B3?



For the second time, and on this occasion, for no very good reason, Alan misses what I consider would have been his best move. (B-K6!) How would I ever get rid of his bishop from e6? Also, the move would force me to waste tempi extricating my queen's knight from the pin upon it.

17. ... N-B4
18. B-Q5

Trying to exploit my undoubted white-squared weakness, but I'm not sure that this was the right was to go about it.

18. ... NxB
19. QxN

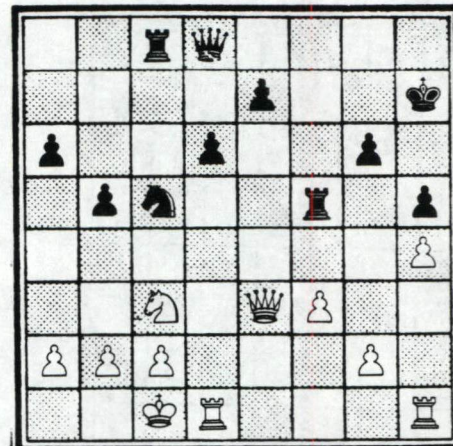
Recapturing with the knight may have been better because my move 19. gains me the initiative.

19. ... R-B4
20. Q-Q4ch K-R2

This was foreseen. I reckon that my king is relatively safe on h7.

21. Q-K3

Yet another queen move by Alan. He has made too many of them in this game, I believe.



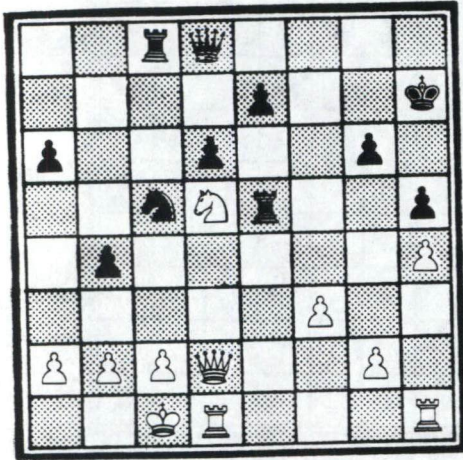
(White really needs to get weaving with his own attack; and black's king, as we can easily see, is much worse off than white's because his pawns are so much further advanced in front of the king. White's Q-K3 was a defensive move, preparing for the advance P-KN4! But it would have been better to let the pawn go at KB3 and play P-KN4 straight away. After 21. P-KN4 RxP 22. PxP white has easily got a pawn's-worth of attack against the open black king side.)

21. ... P-N5
22. N-Q5!

I failed to foresee that this knight manoeuvre forked both my e pawn and my b pawn. I found, however, that, more by luck than judgment, I had an adequate riposte.

22. ... R-K4
23. Q-Q2?

The losing move! 23. Q-B4! winning my b pawn would, in my opinion, have put Alan well on top. I couldn't have saved my b pawn, since I'd have had to play my rook back to f5 to stop Alan from delivering a crushing check with his queen on f7. As becomes apparent straight away, Alan could hardly have placed his queen on a worse square than d2. I smiled and Alan asked, noticing the smile, 'Have you seen something?' 'I think so,' I replied.



23. ... P-N6!!

In my chess experience, this is the most remarkable pawn fork I've ever come across. Normally, pawn forks fork your opponent's pieces. This pawn fork forks Alan's pawns - and neither of them can advance or take the attacking pawn. (a) If BPxP N-N6 double check wins Alan's queen. (b) If RPxP the same thing happens by means of ... N-N6 single check - Alan's c pawn is pinned against his king. (c) If Alan's c pawn advances to c4, ... Pxp on a2!! This threatens to mate by queening. 24. R-R5, the only reply I think, N-N6ch wins black's queen again. (d) If Alan's a pawn advances to a3, which is probably a poor best for him, then ...PxP on c2 leaves him a horrible choice between losing his queen rook next move or his queen a move later - I'm once more threatening ... N-N6ch!!

'Is there any way out for me?' mused Alan aloud as he sat poring over the board. We don't play against the clock so he had as much time as he wanted for thought. At length, he played:-

24. N-B3

(Was there a way out for Alan?

Answer at the end of the game.)

It was my turn to lean forward over the board. 'A good move,' I said, 'but the question must now be, is it good enough?' It blocks the c file and it guards the a pawn and, as Alan pointed out to me afterwards, it leaves open the possibility of his knight coming even further back so as to defend on b1. Is the move good enough then? I looked hard and, quite quickly, a smile returned to my features. 'No,' I informed Alan. 'I don't think it is quite good enough.'

24. ...

PxRP!!

Alan must have stared at the board in silence for ten or fifteen minutes after this. Then, congratulating me, he pushed his king over on its side and resigned.

(11. N-B5ch is a poor sacrifice. After 11. ... PxN 12. Q-N5ch K-R1 white has very little to show for his piece as the black king cannot be 'got at'. Such sacrifices and their acceptance, or declining, belong to the category of 'mental fog' plus timidity. Neither side has the confidence to work out the consequences of the sacrifice in detail, so white sacrifices foggily, hoping that his opponent will be too scared to accept. And black, having little confidence in his own powers of analysis, does the 'safe thing' and declines the offered piece.

After 23. ...P-N6!! I think there was another try by playing 24. K-N1. If then 24... PxRPch 25. K-R1 (or 25. KxP!?) or 24... PxBPch 25. QxP. However, black can still win after 24. K-N1 by playing 24. N-K5! 25. PxN PxBPch, forking king and rook. But this was white's best chance.)

GAME 3

Michael Allcock Memorial Trophy
FINAL 18.7.85.

White: J. E. Savage
Black: J. C. Pritchard

(Notes by the winner; notes in brackets by the editor.)

Ruy Lopez

1. e4

I usually prefer 1. d4 but I suspected that J.P. had something ready for that!

1. ... e5

Dratt and double dratt! John's favourite defence is the Sicilian and I had expected 1...c5 automatically. Prior to this game we had a fierce argument, of which we have many!, about the Sicilian Dragon variation, (1.e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6), I claimed it to be dead and buried but John insisted it was tenable and offered excellent chances. Therefore, the night before this game I spent many hours analysing the critical lines of this defence, feeling sure that my opponent would accept the challenge. And so after black's first move I felt a bit miffed to say the least.

2. Nf3

I was sorely tempted to play a King's Gambit but Pritchard knows that Opening backwards so I decided to play a Giuoco Piano.

2. ... Nc6
3. Bb5

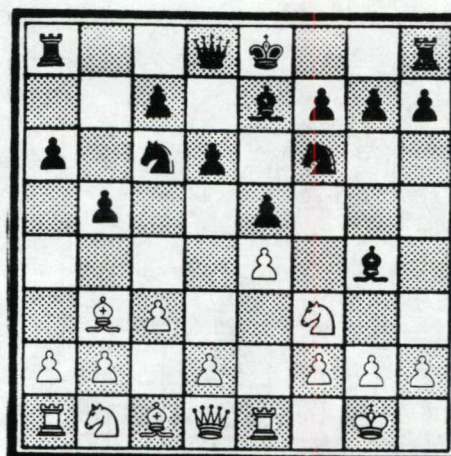
No I wont, I'll play a Lopez

3. ... a6
4. Ba4 Be7

A strange move order but there is no way white can take advantage.

5. 0-0 Nf6
6. Re1 b5

7. Bb3 d6
8. c3 Bg4



Unusual, but sound. I had expected 8...0-0 9.h3 Na5 10.Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7, the Tchigorin Defence which Mr Pritchard usually favours.

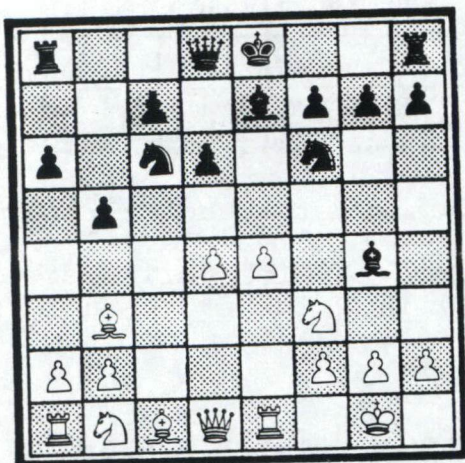
9. d3

'Treat with caution' is stamped all over white's last move!

(The object of this opening, the Ruy Lopez, is that white should try to place two pawns in the centre (first by the move 1.e4, later by the moves c3 followed by d4). If black then captures at d4 by exd4, white can then recapture with his supporting pawn at c3 and, hey presto!, he has his two pawn centre which, in theory, will give the germs of an advantage. Because pieces are more powerful in the middle of the board, and because the black pieces will not be able to get in the centre, therefore they will be less powerful and therefore white will have the advantage.

Now in the present game we do not actually get to build our pawn centre immediately.

After black's Bg4 move, the knight at f3 is pinned. And every pawn centre needs support. If white gaily carries on with his plan of 10. d4 exd4 11. cxd4 we reach the following position:-



The pawn centre cannot now be maintained except by making a certain concession. Black plays 11... Bxf3 and then white will lose the pawn at d4 if he plays 12. Qxf3 Nxd4. On the other hand, if he retains the pawn at d4 (with 12. gxf3, the lesser evil), his king side position is broken up and later in the game the white king could be in danger.

Thus, in the actual game, white does not play 10. d4 immediately, but bides his time with 10. d3 and meanwhile develops his queen side pieces.)

9. ... Na5
10. Bc2 c5
11. Nbd2 O-O
12. h3 Bh5

(Technically, Nf1-g3 is preferred to h3, to prevent the bishop

retreating to h5 after the pawn move h3.)

13. Nf1

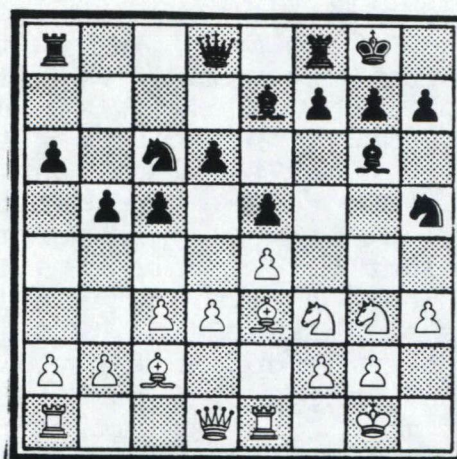
Perhaps stronger was 13. g4 followed by Nf1 and Ng3 heading for the strong outpost at f5.

13. ... Nc6
14. Ng3

Again g4 is probably best, but I felt that this was the move Pritch was trying to entice.- so what if it is 'best'.

14. ... Bg6
15. Be3 Nh5?!

Threatens Nxg3 wrecking white's king side pawns as well as f5 with prospects of attack, but there must be something wrong with such an artificial looking move.



16. Nxe5!

Yes! There it is, white wins a pawn. My opponents expression of puzzlement quickly turned into an embarrassed grin as he realised his cockup!

16. ... Nxe5

Not 16... Nxg3?? 17. Nxg6 and white wins a piece!

17. Nxh5

White is now a clear pawn up.

17. ... f5

Black's only chance is to open the game and hope for a mistake.

18. Nf4

Threatens the horrible fork Ne6 as well as Nxg6.

18. ... Qd7

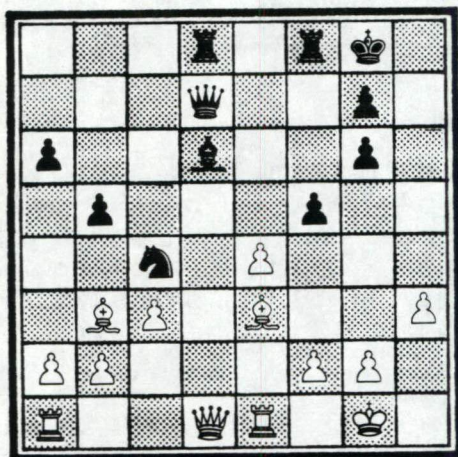
If 18...Bf7, 19.exf and another pawn bites the dust.

19. d4 Nc4
20. Nxg6 hxg6
21. cxc Rad8

The old 'I don't care about pawns' trick eh? If 21... Nxb2 22. Qd5+.

22. cxd Bxd6
23. Bb3

If you're pawns up, you exchange pieces, don't you?



23. ... Qc7

Threatens 24...Bh2+ winning queen for rook.

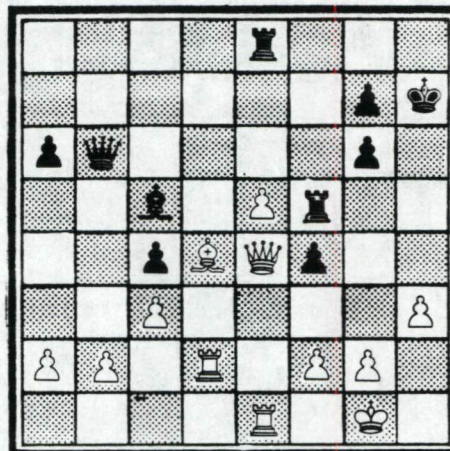
24. Qc2 f4
25. Bd4 Kh7

Unpins his knight. If 25... f3 26. e5 (not 26. g3 Bxg3!) 26...Be7 27.Qxg6 and black would resign.

26. Bxc4

Being two pawns up I decided to simplify and head for an ending.

26... bxc4
27. e5 Bc5
28. Qe4 Rde8
29. Rad1 Rf5
30. Rd2 Qb6



The time control is reached, now black should resign; white has two extra pawns and his pieces are centrally dominant.

31. Bxc5 Qxc5
32. Qd4

Sacrificing a pawn to reach a won ending but, perhaps wiser was 32. e6 sitting on the two pawn advantage.

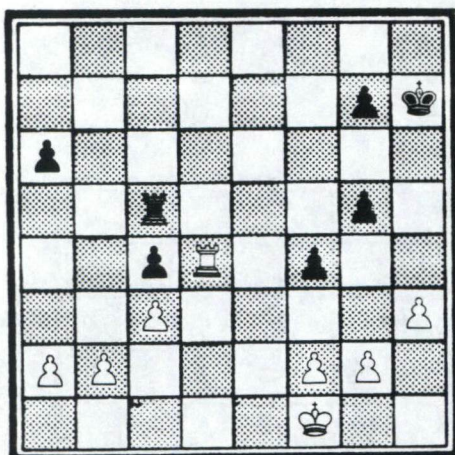
32. ... Rxe5
33. Rxe5 Rxe5
34. Qxc5?!

Why not 34. Qxf4?

34. ... Rxc5
35. Rd4 g5

Here I had to seal. The move I chose was 36. Kf1 but my opponent resigned before resumption. And thus, admittedly with luck, I became club champion.

(Why on earth did he resign?



Admittedly, white is a pawn up with a better position, because his rook is dominant and the enemy pawns are isolated and weak; but this is a rook and pawn ending, and everybody knows that rook and pawn endings can be the hardest to win, even though you are a pawn or two ahead. So black should have fought on to the bitter end with a5 followed by Kg6 - f5 centralising his king.)

GAME 4

Terril Trophy Match Game

White: J. E. Savage
Black: Dr. J. Lanz

King's Indian Defence/London system.

(Notes by the winner; notes in brackets by the editor.)

1. d4

Before this game I had vowed to play an aggressive game with 1.e4 but, as I sat at the board, a dose of cowardice came over me and I flung this pawn forward.

1. ... Nf6
2. Nf3

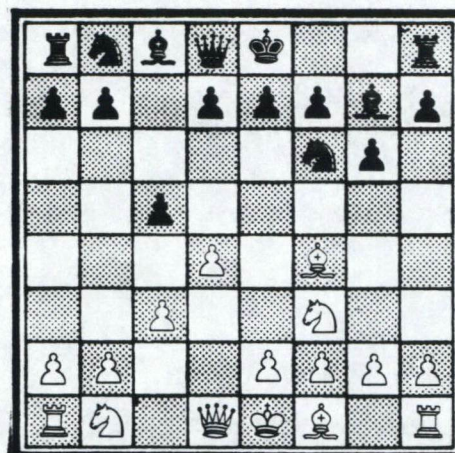
A non-committal move to avoid the Benoni; if now black plays 2...c5 I would reply 3. c3 keeping many options open.

2. ... g6
3. Bf4

The London system, a quiet positional response to the King's Indian, the point of which is to make the black king's bishop bite on granite at d4.

3. ... Bg7
4. c3 c5!

An excellent response aimed directly against white's strategy.



5. e3

dx c5 would be met by 5...Qa5 and if 6. b4 7...Qd8, black would have excellent play on the long diagonal for his bishop and would destroy the white pawns with moves such as Nd5, a5 and Nc6.

5. ... 0-0
6. Bd3 d5

Black realises that white will eventually want to advance his e pawn and so nails it down.

7. Nbd2

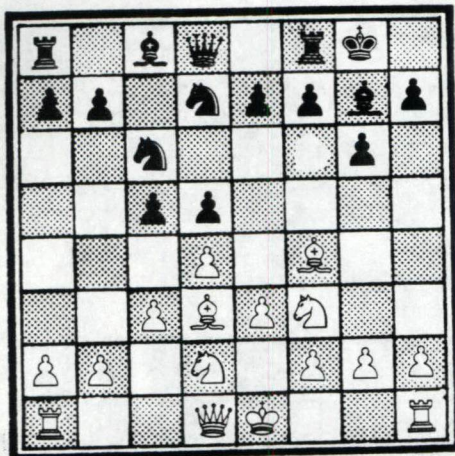
White continues development and awaits to see black's strategy.

7. ... Nc6
8. h3

Black now has no satisfactory square for his queen's bishop and white's queen's bishop is protected from Nh5.

8. ... Nd7

Black's idea now becomes clear, he wants to smash the white centre completely with e5.



9. 0-0 e5
10. dxe5

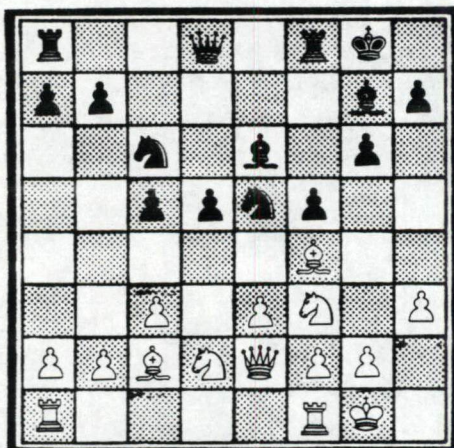
White hopes he can weather the storm

10. ... Ndx5
11. Bc2 11. f5!

As Dr. Lanz's fingers grasped this pawn my heart sank, I had hoped to play 12. e4 with a good game.

12. Qe2 Be6

An interesting thought now came to me, did he think I wanted to play c4? I had considered this a bad move as it would enhance black's bishop on g7, I now went into a trance for 30 minutes over my next move!



13. Rfd1

Which rook? Which bloody rook?

I kept saying to myself. I decided on the king's rook because Rad1 would leave a pawn en prise and black would have come fascinating possibilities starting with 13...d4!? The point of 13. Rfd1 is to threaten 14. e4!

13. ... Qe7

Nullifies the threat as white does not now have the tactical possibility of Nxe4.

14. Bb3!?

Threatens Ng5 followed by e4 and also lays a trap.

14. ... c4?!

Yes, he did think I wanted to play c4, I now felt much better as white has an excellent base for his knights on d4.

15. Bc2

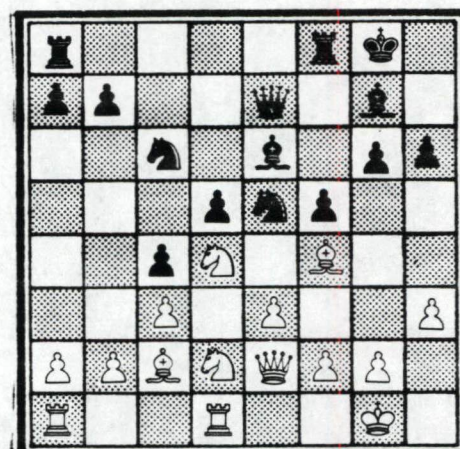
This bishop is destined for a great future.

15. ... h6

Prevents Ng5 or Bg5 and prepares a pawn storm on the white king.

16. Nd4

After this move I had 9 minutes left to make 14 moves!



16. ... g5
17. Bxe5 Nxe5

(I do not think white should have parted with his strong bishop so freely; 17. Bh2

looks better. Ed)

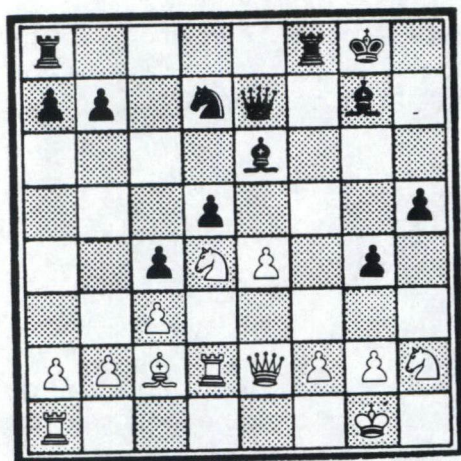
18. N2f3 Nd7
19. Rd2 g4

(and instead of 19.Rd2, 19.
Nxe6 Qxe6 20. Nd4 looks
stronger.)

20. Nh2 h5
21. hxg4 fxg4??

Black, seeing that white was
very short on time, played his
moves very quickly hoping to
force me into a bad error but
he errs first!

22. e4!



White at last gets in e4, I
now threaten to win a piece
by 23. exd5. Black cannot now
play 22...dxe4 because 23.Qxe4
and white has a fantastic attack.

22. ... Rae8
23. Rael

Renews the threat of exd5 win-
ning a piece

23. ... Qh4?

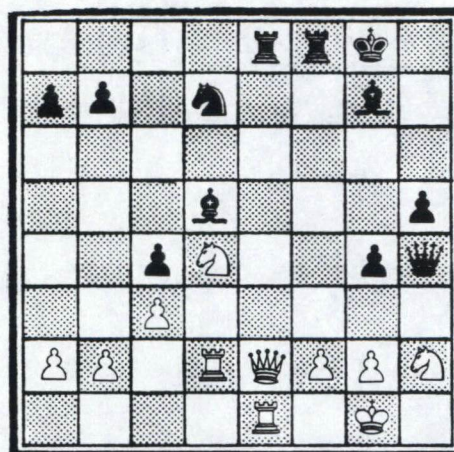
played almost instantly and black
had over 20 minutes left! 23...
Qg5! should win or even 23...Qd8.

(Is this so? 24.Nxe6 25. Rxe6
25. Rxd5 Qxd5 26. exd5 Rxe2 is
okay for white.)

24. exd5

At this point I had about 2½
minutes for the remaining five
moves. I started swaying in
my chair and, glancing at the clock,
saw my flag rising impossibly
quickly; also I had started to
attract unwanted spectators.

24. ... Bxd5



25. Qxe8

an instant decision

25. ... Rxe8
26. Rxe8+ Kf7
27. Nf5 Qg5
28. Nd6+ Kf6

The only square on the board for
the black king!

29. Nf1 Bc6
30. Rde2

I slumped back in my chair re-
lieved to have reached the time
control. I now threaten mate by
Re6.

continued on page 20

CHOOSE YOUR MOVE!

In this article we are starting a new way to present chess games.

Play through the first 4 moves of the game and then cover up the page so you cannot see the rest of the game.

After each move you are given three choices and you should either circle the move of your choice, or write it down on a separate piece of paper. Do not look at the commentary, which is on the page overleaf, yet but play through the game till the end, choosing your move each time.

At the end of the game there are three further questions on the detailed analysis of some of the positions.

Overleaf you will find a commentary on the game, plus points scoring for each move; the higher the points, the better the move.

Finally, you can add up the points scored for your choices and your analysis, and calculate your marks out of 100 to reveal your rating. I would be interested to know if my estimated ratings actually do tally with readers grades!

White: Bailey New South Wales Junior Championship 1950.
Black: Anon.

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Bc5 4. d3 d6

White	Black	A	B	C
Choose white's move		Nf3	f4	Bb5+
5. f4	Nc6	Nf3	fxe5	f5
6. f5	O-O	g4	Nf3	Bg5
7. Nf3	Ng4	Ng5	h3	Rf1
8. Rf1	Nxh2	Nxh2	Ng5	Rh1
9. Ng5	Nxf1	Kxf1	Nxf7	Qh5
10. Qh5	h6	Nxf7	Qg6	Bxf7+
11. Nxf7	Rxf7	Bxf7	Qxf7+	Kxf1
12. Qxf7+	Kh7	Qg6+	Bg5	Bxh6
13. Bg5	Qxg5	Qg8+	Qg6+	Nd5
14. Qg8++				

Questions: (10 points for each)

- (A) Analyse the position after 11. Qg6 (instead of 11. Nxf7).
What is best play for both sides?
- (B) Does 11. Bxf7+ (instead of Nxf7) Rxf7 12. Qxf7+ Kh8 win for white? Give variations.
- (C) Was 12...Kh8 better for black than the move played 12...Kh7?
Give analysis.

Commentary and scoring

5. Nf3 (4) f4 (6) Bb5+ (1)

Nf3 is a good developing move. f4 is more committal but gives white a possible open file and pressure on black's centre. Bb5+ wastes time after c6.

6. Nf3 (6) fxe5 (3) f5 (6)

Nf3 is once again a good developing move; fxe5 allows Nxe5 attacking the bishop at c4. f5 puts a clamp on the black position and makes it very dangerous for black to castle king side due to white's advantage of space.

7. g4 (4) Nf3 (6) Bg5 (6)

After black's disastrous decision to castle, white has a good choice of moves. g4 starts a pawn roller on the king side which keeps white's advantage. Nf3 is once again the simple developing move. Bg5, pinning the knight, is also very strong as white now has the threat of Nd5 and Nxf6+, doubling the pawns in black's kingside.

8. Ng5 (5) h3 (1) Rf1 (6)

Black has a threat here of Nf2 forking king and rook, so h3 is a poor move. Ng5 has a lot to be said for it as, if black continues with Nf2, the reply Qh5 is very powerful. However, 8.Ng5 could be answered by Bf2+ 9. Kf1 Ne3+ 10. Bxe3 Bxe3 and black beats off the attack. Rf1 prevents the threatened Nf2.

9. Nxh2 (2) Ng5 (7) Rh1 (4)

Black's piece sacrifice by Nxh2 should not be accepted as, after 9. Nxh2 Qh4+ 10. Ke2 Qxh2, black regains his piece with advantage.

Rh1 is a good move; now, after 9...Nxf3+ 10. Qxf3, white has the open h file to play down against black's king.

The strongest move is 9. Ng5, beginning an all out assault on the black king.

10. Kxf1 (2) Nxf7 (2) Qh5 (7)

Kxf1 would be pointless; white, having sacrificed material must show he has attacking ideas in mind, otherwise he has no compensation. But 10. Nxf7 does not gain any advantage; after 10...Rxf7 11. Bxf7+ Kxf7 12. Qh5+ Kg8 the white attack fizzles out.

10. Qh5! is the only correct move with a threat of mate at h7 and a further attack on the f7 square.

11. Nxf7 (8) Qg6 (5) Bxf7+ (7)

The analysis of the moves Qg6 and Bxf7+ follow at the end of this section as they are part of the 'additional analysis' questions.

12. Bxf7+ (4) Qxf7+ (6) Kxf1 (2)

Qxf7+ is the best way to continue attacking; Bxf7+ can be answered by 12...Kf8! 13. Bc4 Qf6 or Qe8.

13. Qg6+ (2) Bg5 (10) Bxh6 (5)

A critical moment and, at first sight, the move Bxh6 wins since if 13...Kxh6 14. Qg6 is mate. But black has at least two good defences. One is to support g7 by playing 13...Qf6 14. Qg8+ Kxh6 15. Qh8+ Kg5.

The other is by counter attack; 13...Qh4+! 14. Kd1 (14.Kf1?? Qf2++) Qg4+! (not 14...Qxh6?? 15. Qg8++). 15. Kc1 Kxh6 and there is now no mate by Qg6.

13. Qg6+ Kh8 does not further white's attack, but the beautiful move 13. Bg5! does; black's three main defences are now mated in three separate ways: 13...hxxg5 14. Qh5 mate; 13...Qh8 14.Qg6++.

14. Qg8+ (8) Qg6+ (2) Nd5 (2)

Only Qg8 is mate.

Answers to analytical questions; give yourself up to 10 points according to how much of this analysis you saw.

(A) After 11. Qg6 (threatening Qh7++) black cannot capture by 11...fxg6 because the pawn at f7 is pinned by the bishop at c4. But black can play 11...hxxg5 12. Bxxg5 and now not 12...Qe8? 13.Bf6 with check mate but 12...Ne7! or 12...d5! (breaking the pin) 13. Bxd5 Qxd5!! 14.exd5 fxg6 and black emerges with a large material advantage.

(B) 11. Bxf7+ Rxf7+ 12.Qxf7+ Kh8 can lead to victory if followed up correctly.

13. f6! now if Qxf6 14. Qe8+ mates and, if 13...hxxg5 14.Qh5 or 13...gxxf6 14.Qh7 are also mate, so instead black plays 13...Qg8! 14. Qg6! and black is helpless. 14...hxxg5 15. f7 Qf8 16. Qh5++. Or 14...Be6 15. f7 Bxf7 16. Nxf7+ winning black's queen.

(C) At first sight there is no difference between 12...Kh8 and 12...Kh7. White still plays 13. Bg5 with similar variations. But after 13. Bg5 black has the defence ...Be6! 14. Bxe6 Qxxg5 and there is no mate at g8.

Against 12...Kh7 13.Bg5, the defence 13...Be6 does not work because white can play 14. Qg6+ followed by Bxd8.

Does this mean that 12...Kh8 was better than Kh7? No - white can still win by 13. f6! since if 13... Qxf6 14. Qg8 is mate and if 13...gxxf6 14. Bxh6 also leads to mate.

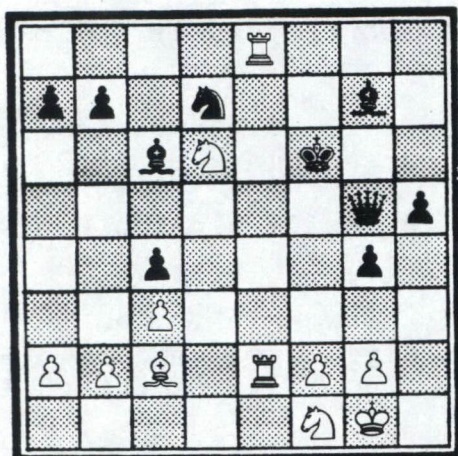
Now add up your scores for the game. Maximum score: 100
Your score _____

Ranking and estimate grading:-

<u>Score on the game</u>	<u>Ranking</u>	<u>Grade</u>
90 or more	Expert	140 or above
80 or more	Club player	120 or above
70 or more	Average club player	100
60 or more	novice	80
50 or more	beginner	60
below 50	you still learned a lot from this game.	

If you enjoyed playing through the game presented in this manner, there are 25 other games in the new book 'Choose your move', available from Audio Chess, 7 Billockby Close, Chessington, Surrey, KT9 2ED at £3.95 + 20p. p. & p.

continued from page 16



30. ... Nc5
31. R8e5 Qxe5

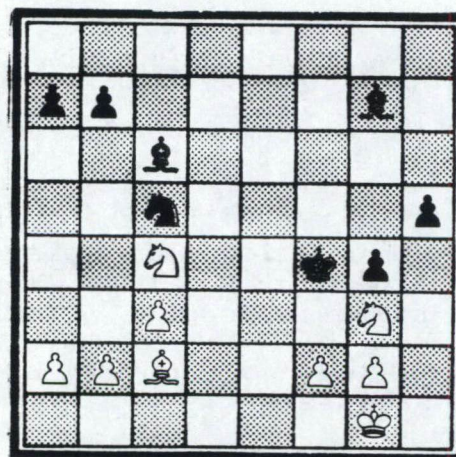
Black doesn't want to lose his knight.

32. Rxe5 Kxe5
33. Nxc4+

After the smoke has cleared white has emerged a single pawn up but black has the two bishops and with accurate play the game would probably be drawn.

33. ... Kf4
34. Ng3

with the transparent threat of Nxh5+



34. ... h4???

A horrible end to a very interesting game.

35. Nh5+ Black resigns.